

CERITEC[®] FILM COATED TABLET 10MG

Ingredient(s):

Each tablet contains:

Cetirizine Hydrochloride.....10mg

Pharmacodynamics:

Cetirizine is an anti-H₁ agent with minimal anticholinergic or antiserotonin activities. At pharmacological doses, it induces neither sedation nor behavioural changes. This is because Cetirizine does not readily cross the blood-brain barrier. It was shown in human pharmacological studies that Cetirizine will inhibit certain effects produced by exogenous histamine. This activity appears rapidly. Cetirizine inhibits the effects produced by endogenous histamine released in vivo by an agent, eg. 48/80. It inhibits cutaneous reaction induced by VIP (Vasoactive Intestinal Polypeptide) and substance P, neuropeptides which are believed to take part in the allergic reaction. Cetirizine blocks histamine-induced bronchoconstriction in the asthmatic patients. It also reduces the allergic reaction induced by specific allergens. These effects are obtained without any central effects being demonstrated either by psychometric test or by a quantified EEG.

Pharmacokinetic:

Absorption: Well absorbed after oral administration. Food may delay the rate, but not the extent of cetirizine absorption.

Protein binding: 93%

Biotransformation: Cetirizine is minimally metabolized and excreted unchanged primarily through the kidneys.

Half-life: 8 hours (range, 6.5 to 10 hours).

Onset of action: Histamine skin wheal studies: 0.5 hours following 10mg dose.

Time to peak concentration: 1 hour.

Duration of action: Up to 24 hours.

Elimination: Approximately 60% of the total dose administered is excreted unchanged in urine within 24 hours; about 10% is excreted in feces.

Indication(s):

Perennial rhinitis, seasonal allergic rhinitis, acute & chronic urticaria, allergic conjunctivitis.

Dosage and Administration:

Adults: 10mg once daily.

Children: ≥ 6 years: 5 mg twice daily or 10mg once daily.

3-6 years: 2.5mg twice daily or 5mg once daily.

Patients with Renal Insufficiency: Dosage should be reduced to ½ the daily dose.

Route of Administration: Oral**Precaution(s) / Warning(s):**

At therapeutic doses, cetirizine does not potentiate the effect of alcohol (at a blood level of 0.5g/L). However, caution should be exercised.

Activities Requiring Mental Alertness: In clinical trial the occurrence of somnolence has been reported in some patients taking Cetirizine: due caution should therefore be exercised when driving a car or operating potentially dangerous machinery. Studies in healthy volunteers on 20 or 25 mg/day have not revealed effects on alertness or reaction time. Patient should be advised, however, to take care not to exceed the recommended dose.

Pregnancy and Lactation:

Use in pregnancy and lactation: Cetirizine was not teratogenic in mice, rats and rabbits. As a precaution, however, cetirizine should not be administered to pregnant women during the first 3 months of pregnancy, nor women who are breastfeeding. Cetirizine is contraindicated in lactating women since cetirizine is excreted in breastmilk.

Drug Interactions:

To date, there are no known interactions with other drugs. Nevertheless, cetirizine should be used with caution if sedatives are also taken.

Side Effect(s) / Adverse Reaction(s):

When cetirizine is administered at recommended doses, any side effects that may occur, eg. agitation, dry mouth, or headache, do not differ significantly from placebo. Very occasionally, symptoms of hypersensitivity have been reported.

Contraindications:

Patients with a hypersensitivity to cetirizine.

Use in lactation: Cetirizine is contraindicated in lactating women since cetirizine is excreted in breastmilk.

Symptoms and Treatment for Overdosage, and Anti-Dote:

Drowsiness can be a symptom of overdose, occurring from administration of 50mg cetirizine as a single dose. There is no specific antidote for overdose of cetirizine, treatment is symptomatic and supportive. Gastric lavage should be performed as soon as possible. Usual supportive measures should be provided and routine observation carried out regularly.

Shelf-Life:

3 years from the date of manufacture.

Storage Condition(s):

Store at temperature below 30°C. Protect from light and moisture.

Product Description and Packing(s):

A white to off-white film coated tablet, one side impressed with the 2 Y's separated by a line scored in the middle



Blister Packing of 10's x 2, 10's x 10, 10's x 50, 10's x 100.



Manufacturer and Product Registration Holder:
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